

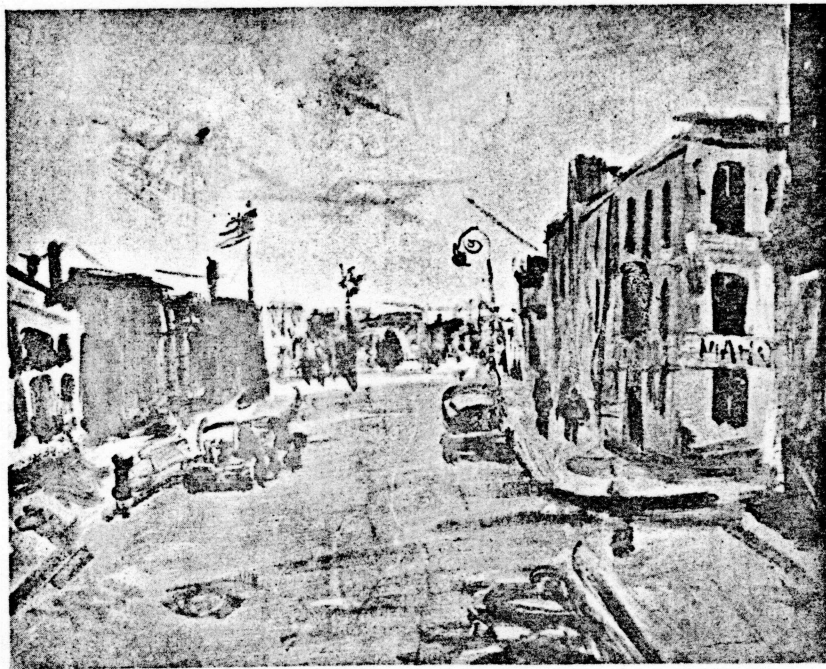
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Suburban Street: MAURICE SIEVAN.

Contemporary Arts Exhibits Its Happy Brood

TRIBALLY INCREASED to the fulsome number of 27 artists, the Contemporary Arts Gallery's "sponsored group" has put on a show at its alertly managed establishment that comprises nearly 50 oils, on view until Sept. 12. And in addition to this large regular group show, the artists have filled another room with a series of \$5-\$50 small-sized canvases particularly inviting to the timid beginner in art collecting.

The main exhibition contains a variety of styles and subjects and has the element of surprise that has become almost a stamp of the gallery. Stephen Csoka sent a romantic sequence titled *Escapade* that contains some of his most exultant passages in painting, spontaneous yet controlled. There's a dusky, sooty nocturne by Harold Baumbach with a retired pink grocery wagon as the main interest; there is another one of Max Schnitzler's riotously colorful diurnes; Maurice Sievan

has made over a drab suburban street into a picture packed with charm.

Two of the gallery's hard-headed realists, M. A. Tricca and John C. Pellew, present life in the raw, urban and rural. The former's *City Skyscape* looms suddenly into the darkened sky with a jolt. Pellew's *Uprooted* gives the other side of life—the sculptured twistings of Dame Nature when she is given a fast mountain stream and a few fallen trees. Respite from these adventures is quickly provided in the show by clean and ozonous beach scenes of Leighton Smith and fanciful dreams from the brush of Lawrence Lebduka.

The show moves fast with scenic, mood and stylistic changes; the artists keep their sense of balance and wit amid experiments; individualism is joyously rampant; and there is indication everywhere that both the artists and the gallery like their jobs.